

MAYRA SÁENZ

Citizenship: Ecuadorian
Italian Residence Permit

[Website
mayraas2@illinois.edu](http://mayraas2@illinois.edu)

AFFILIATION

Assistant Professor in Economics, Universidad del Rosario 2024 -

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Household and Demographic Economics, Applied Microeconomics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Illinois (UIUC) 2024

with Minor in *Gender Relations in International Development*

M.A. in Development Economics, Latin American Faculty of Social Sciences (FLACSO) 2011

B.Sc. in Marketing Engineering, Armed Forces Polytechnic School (ESPE) 2009

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Prof. Arends-Kuenning, UIUC 2022 - 2024

Research Assistant, Prof. Pflugh Prescott and Prof. Ellison, UIUC 2021 - 2023

Consultant, World Bank - Nicaragua Country Office (Summer job) 2022

Consultant, World Bank - DECPI 2019 - 2021

Research Assistant, Prof. Michelson, UIUC 2019

Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank - Social Sector (Summer job) 2018

Social Research Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank - Social Sector 2013-2017

Researcher, FLACSO - Department of Economics 2011-2013

WORKING PAPERS

[Can Institutional Factors Affect Intergenerational Family Transfers?](#)

[The effect of monetary losses due to weather shocks on food security in Malawi: A subjective approach](#), 2020.

[Analysis of the tax reform in Ecuador, 2001-2012.](#) (with [V. Aguiar](#) and L. Castro). *Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean*. Macroeconomics of the Development Series No.143, 2013.

[Ex-ante impacts of three commercial agreements in the Ecuadorian economy](#) (with [V. Aguiar](#) and H. Jacome). *Linea Sur Magazine*, 2012.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Pathways into single motherhood and their implications for children’s wellbeing in Nicaragua” (with [M. Arends-Kuenning](#) and [C. Herrera](#)).

“To waste or not to waste? Exploring the complexity of student dietary behaviors in school cafeterias” (with [M. Pflugh Prescott](#), [B. Ellison](#), [R. Ofori](#), S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

“Students’ peer effects on food selection and consumption” (with [M. Pflugh Prescott](#), [B. Ellison](#), [R. Ofori](#), S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

“An agent-based model of the school cafeteria and meal patterns: Feedback of school nutrition stakeholders” (with [M. Pflugh Prescott](#), [B. Ellison](#), [R. Ofori](#), S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

JOURNAL ARTICLES

[MealSim: Data-Driven Predictions of Child Selection, Consumption, and Waste Behaviors to Promote Increased Fruit and Vegetable Consumption](#) (with [M. Prescott](#), [B. Ellison](#), [R. Ofori](#), [I. Ciubotariu](#), and [S. Palmer](#)) *Journal of Nutrition Education and Behavior*, 55(7), 111., 2023.

[Poverty, vulnerability, and the middle class in Latin America](#) (with [M. Stampini](#), [M. Robles](#), [P. Ibarraran](#), and [N. Medellin](#)). *Latin American Economic Review*, 2016.

BOOK CHAPTERS

[Intergenerational persistence in education](#), (with [M. Robles](#)). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Social Pulse in Latin America and the Caribbean 2017: Family Legacy, Breaking the Mold or Repeating Patterns?* (pp. 12-41). Inter-American Development Bank.

[Indicators of context and indicators of outcome](#), (with [S. Duryea](#), [S. Insfrán](#), [M. Robles](#), [V. Saldarriaga](#) and [D. Zuluaga](#)). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Social Pulse in Latin America and the Caribbean 2017: Family Legacy, Breaking the Mold or Repeating Patterns?* (pp. 84-140). Inter-American Development Bank.

[Indicators of context and indicators of outcome](#), (with [S. Duryea](#), [M. Robles](#), [M. Rubio](#), and [D. Saric](#)). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Latin American and Caribbean Social Pulse 2016: realities and perspectives* (pp. 25-63). Inter-American Development Bank.

[The case of Ecuador](#), (with [L. Czarnecki](#) and [E. Balleza](#)). *Poverty and inequality in Ecuador, Brazil, and Mexico after the 2008 global crisis*. Peter Lang GmbH, Internationaler Verlag der Wissenschaften.

SCHOLARSHIPS, HONORS AND AWARDS

Conference Travel Award, UIUC (<i>Summer, Fall</i>)	2023
Award for the Most Outstanding Second Year Research Paper, UIUC	2019
Chester Bull Roberts Fellowship, UIUC	2018
M. Frances Henry Fellowship, UIUC	2017 - 2018
Merit-based Fellowship, MA in Development Economics, FLACSO	2009-2011
Award for the Most Outstanding Student in Marketing Engineering, ESPE	2009
Academic Excellence Scholarship, ESPE	2004 - 2008

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

<i>Graduate Teacher Certificate</i> . The Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning. UIUC	2022
<i>Manage Successful Impact Evaluation Surveys course</i> . Auditor Certificate. World Bank	2021
<i>Multidimensional Poverty Analysis</i> . Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI) University of Oxford	2016
<i>Labor Markets, Poverty and Inequality</i> . Center for Distributive, Labor and Social Studies (CEDLAS) University of La Plata	2012

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

<i>World Food Economy</i> (Undergraduate), UIUC, Teaching Assistant	2019 - 2022
<i>Behavioral Economics</i> (Undergraduate), UIUC, Teaching Assistant	2020
<i>Development Economics Thesis Advisor</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Instructor	2012 - 2013
<i>Quantitative Methods</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2012
<i>Political Economy for Development</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2012
<i>Applied Statistics Workshop</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2011
<i>General Algebraic Modeling System Workshop</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2011

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

- 2024** - University of El Rosario, Population Association of America (PAA)- Applied Demographic Conference (ADC), Workshop on Determinants of Adult Mortality, Morbidity, and Healthy Aging in LMICs at The Berkeley Center on the Economics and Demography of Aging (CEDA), Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev)
- 2023** - Population Association of America (PAA), Sociology Colloquia Seminar, Center for Global Studies (CGS) Webinar, Gender Relations in International Development (GRID) Seminar, Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association (LACEA)
- 2020** - Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA)
- 2013** - Swiss Sociological Association Conference (University of Bern)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

<i>President</i> , Agricultural and Consumer Economics (ACE) Graduate Student Organization, UIUC	2020 - 2021
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SKILLS

Software:	STATA, SPSS, R
Language:	English (Proficient), Spanish (Native), Italian (Advanced)